



INDIA'S BEST AND WORST CONSTITUENCIES

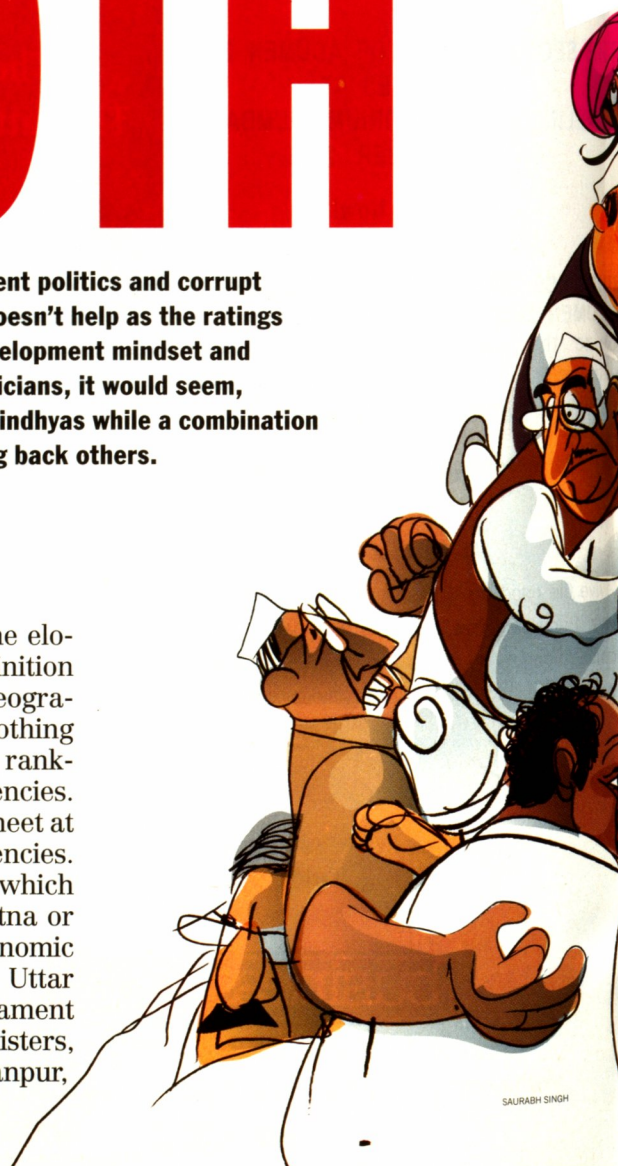
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The rankings reflect the harsh reality of rent politics and corrupt governance. Electing iconic MPs clearly doesn't help as the ratings show. What does matter is a legacy of development mindset and better governance at the state level. Politicians, it would seem, deliver better when located south of the Vindhyas while a combination of slothful babudom and politics is holding back others.

■ By Shankkar Aiyar

Nothing quite compares with the eloquence of numbers. By definition India is a mosaic of cultures, geographies and economies. And nothing symbolises this better than the rankings of the Lok Sabha constituencies.

Bihar makes its debut on the ranking sheet at 330 in a field of 543 Lok Sabha constituencies. The best constituency of the state, which sends 40 MPs to the Lok Sabha, is Patna or Patliputra, ranked 330 on the socio-economic index and 414 for infrastructure. Uttar Pradesh, which sends 80 MPs to Parliament and has been home to eight prime ministers, makes an entry at number 212 with Kanpur,



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